

UNDERSTANDING

KOGI

A plain-language guide to the platform
for everyone from first-time users to technical teams

FOR EVERYONE · 2025

How to Use This Guide

Kogi is a complex platform serving many different kinds of people — freelancers managing clients, cooperatives running democratic organizations, developers building on the platform, and executives making investment decisions. This document is designed to be useful for all of them.

The guide is organized in five sections, each written for a different audience. Jump to the section that matches your background, or read all five — each one reveals a different dimension of the same platform.

Section	Written For	Key Questions Answered
Section 1: The Simple Version	Anyone — no background needed	What is Kogi? What does it do? Why would I use it?
Section 2: The Freelancer's View	Independent workers, freelancers, solopreneurs	How does Kogi make my work life better? What specific problems does it solve?
Section 3: The Cooperative's View	Worker-owned businesses, DAOs, democratic organizations	How does Kogi support collective ownership and governance?
Section 4: The Business View	Business owners, managers, executives, operators	How does Kogi change how my organization runs?
Section 5: The Technical View	Developers, architects, technology leaders	How is Kogi built? What are the technical components and integration points?

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The Simple Version

What is Kogi, explained plainly

FOR: ANYONE — NO BACKGROUND REQUIRED

What is Kogi?

Kogi is a platform — a place on your phone or computer — where you can manage everything about your work life in one spot. Think of it as a control center for people who work for themselves, run small businesses, or belong to worker-owned organizations.

THINK OF IT THIS WAY:

Kogi is like a Swiss Army knife for work — but with AI inside.

Instead of carrying a separate knife, screwdriver, scissors, and bottle opener, Kogi combines your work planner, bank account, invoice system, team communication, and business tools in one place — and they all know what each other is doing.

What Can You Do With Kogi?

- Organize and track your projects and tasks (like a to-do list that actually thinks)
- Send invoices and get paid — automatically connected to your project work
- Manage your money in specialized accounts for savings, taxes, benefits, and emergencies
- Find skilled people to help with projects — and pay them securely through the platform
- Run a democratic organization — make group decisions, vote on proposals, manage shared money
- Get an AI assistant that watches everything and tells you what needs attention today

The Big Idea

Most working people use lots of different apps — one for tasks, one for money, one for communication, one for finding help. The problem is those apps don't talk to each other. You spend hours copying information between them and things fall through the cracks.

Kogi connects all of these things. When you finish a project, it helps create the invoice automatically. When you get paid, it puts the right amount in your tax savings account. When you need help, it finds qualified people from its marketplace. Everything is connected, so you spend less time managing tools and more time doing actual work.

Who Is Kogi For?

Freelancers & Independent Workers

People who work for themselves and manage multiple clients at once.

Example: *A web designer who juggles 5 clients, tracks invoices, and needs to find a copywriter for a new project.*

Worker-Owned Cooperatives

Groups of people who own their business together and make decisions democratically.

Example: *A 12-person design studio where all members vote on which projects to take, how to split profits, and when to hire.*

Small Teams & Organizations

Any group of 2–20 people working toward shared goals.

Example: *A nonprofit's project team managing grant-funded work across multiple programs and tracking every dollar.*

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The Freelancer's View

How Kogi solves the everyday problems of independent workers

FOR: INDEPENDENT WORKERS, FREELANCERS, CONSULTANTS, SOLOPRENEURS

The Problem Kogi Solves for You

If you work for yourself, you probably know this feeling: you're good at your actual work, but you spend half your time managing the business side of it. Tracking which projects are where, chasing late payments, setting aside enough for taxes, keeping track of expenses, finding good people to collaborate with — it never ends.

Kogi is designed to handle all of that — automatically, in one place, with an AI that watches out for you.

Your Day on Kogi

SCENARIO: JORDAN'S MORNING

Jordan is a UX consultant with 4 active clients. She opens Kogi at 9am. Before she types anything, the AI has already checked everything: one project is behind schedule, a \$3,200 invoice from last month is 12 days overdue, a governance vote in her design collective closes today, and two qualified contractors are available who could help with the delayed project. All of this is summarized in one clear briefing with action buttons. In 10 minutes, she sends the invoice reminder, approves the contractor outreach, and casts her vote — without leaving the app.

Kogi's Work Board: Your Project Brain

The work board is where you manage everything you're working on. Think of it like a smart sticky-note board that organizes itself. You can see all your projects at once, break them into tasks, track what's done, and see exactly what needs attention today.

- Create projects and break them down into tasks and milestones
- Drag tasks between columns as you make progress (To Do → In Progress → Done)
- Set priorities, deadlines, and connect tasks to specific client invoices
- Get automatic alerts when a deadline is approaching or a task is falling behind

Kogi Bank: Your Financial Co-Pilot

One of the hardest parts of working for yourself is managing money when income is unpredictable. Kogi Bank is designed specifically for this — with smart accounts that automatically handle your financial life.

Account	What It Does	Why It Matters
Operating Account	Your main working account for day-to-day expenses	Your business checking account, connected to invoices
Tax Reserve	Automatically saves the right % of every payment	No more scrambling at tax time — the money is already set aside
Income Protection	Builds a buffer for slow months	Smooths out feast-or-famine income cycles
Professional Development	Dedicated fund for courses, tools, and certifications	Invest in yourself without dipping into operating funds
Emergency Savings	3–6 month runway built up over time	Freelance safety net — job loss protection built in
Retirement	Long-term wealth building, portable across all clients	The retirement account your employer doesn't offer

The Marketplace: Your Talent Network

When you need help — a developer for a design project, a copywriter for a website, a video editor for a campaign — Kogi's Marketplace is built right into your work management flow. No tab-switching, no separate platform.

- Post a request from directly inside a blocked project task
- Browse verified professionals with portfolios connected to their Kogi work history
- Contract, pay, and manage everything through built-in escrow and milestone payments
- The AI will search for matching contractors automatically when it detects a project is stuck

THINK OF IT THIS WAY:

Think of Kogi's AI as your very own chief of staff.

A chief of staff reads every email, knows every deadline, tracks every project, and tells their boss exactly what matters today — and what to do about it. Kogi's AI (called Oba) does all of this for you automatically, scanning all your projects, invoices, accounts, and deadlines every morning and turning them into a clear action list.

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The Cooperative's View

Democratic ownership, transparent governance, shared finance

FOR: WORKER COOPERATIVES, DAOS, DEMOCRATIC ORGANIZATIONS, MEMBER-OWNED GROUPS

Why Cooperatives Need Different Tools

Running a worker-owned organization is fundamentally different from running a traditional business. Decisions are made democratically. Profits are shared. Members have rights and responsibilities. Finance is transparent to everyone. And every major change needs a vote.

Most business software ignores all of this. It assumes a hierarchy — an owner at the top, employees below. Kogi is built for the other way: a group of equals, working together, with tools that match how cooperatives actually function.

Governance: Democracy in Software

Kogi's governance tools make democratic decision-making fast, transparent, and accountable. Any member can propose a change. All members vote. Decisions are recorded permanently. Funds are released automatically when votes pass.

Proposal System

Any member can write and submit a proposal — a budget request, a new policy, a hire decision, a project direction. The AI can help draft proposals based on platform data.

Example: A cooperative votes on whether to accept a \$25,000 project. The proposal includes the project scope, expected workload per member, and projected earnings per person — all auto-populated by Kogi.

Transparent Treasury

Every financial movement — incoming payments, payroll runs, expense approvals — is visible to all members with the permissions to see it. No surprises, no hidden fees, no trust-me accounting.

Example: Before the monthly payroll run, every member can see exactly how much revenue came in, what expenses are being deducted, and what each person will receive — before it happens.

Cooperative Payroll

Kogi can distribute earnings to all members according to your cooperative's rules — equal split, hours-weighted, contribution-based, or any formula you define. It handles the calculation, the transfer, and the records.

Example: A 7-person cooperative pays out monthly. Each person logged different hours. Kogi calculates each person's share based on the hours-weighted formula the group voted on last quarter, then executes all 7 transfers.

Cooperative Finance Instruments

Kogi Bank supports financial structures that traditional banks simply don't offer for groups that aren't corporations. These instruments let cooperatives pool, invest, and protect resources together.

Instrument	What It Is	When You'd Use It
Cooperative Treasury	Shared operating account with multi-signature controls	Day-to-day expenses, payroll, project costs
Revenue Sharing Pool	Distributes a % of all incoming revenue to members automatically	Cooperatives that want automatic earnings distribution
Group Investment Pool	Members contribute to a shared investment fund with collective governance	Cooperatives saving for equipment, expansion, or opportunities
Mutual Aid Fund	Emergency financial support for members in need	When a member faces unexpected hardship
Crowdresourcing Pool	Members contribute labor toward a shared goal with tracked reward rules	Cooperative projects that need collective effort
Collective Escrow	Holds client payments until delivery is confirmed by the group	Client contracts requiring group delivery confirmation

Community & Organization Spaces

Kogi's community module lets cooperatives create structured spaces for different functions — governance discussions, project work, social connection, education, and public-facing presence. Members interact within a clear permission structure that matches how your cooperative is organized.

- Create different spaces for different purposes (Board meetings, Project rooms, Social spaces)
- Control who can see, post, and moderate in each space
- Host events, share resources, and coordinate collective action
- Build a public-facing presence that showcases your cooperative's work

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The Business View

How Kogi changes how organizations operate

FOR: BUSINESS OWNERS, MANAGERS, OPERATORS, EXECUTIVES, TEAM LEADS

The Integrated Operations Platform

For business operators, Kogi's value proposition is straightforward: it replaces a fragmented collection of tools — project management, financial management, HR & payroll, marketplace sourcing, governance, and business intelligence — with a single integrated platform where data flows between every function automatically.

The compounding effect of this integration is significant. Consider what happens today when you close a project milestone: you likely need to update a project management tool, create an invoice in a separate billing system, notify finance about expected cash, and update a spreadsheet. In Kogi, completing a milestone triggers all of this automatically — the invoice is created, the cash flow forecast is updated, and the relevant accounts are flagged for incoming payment.

Key Workflows Kogi Automates

Workflow	Without Kogi	With Kogi
Project-to-invoice	Manual: export milestone → open billing app → create invoice → send	Automatic: milestone completion triggers invoice creation and sending
Payment-to-allocation	Manual: check bank → move money to tax/savings → update spreadsheet	Automatic: payment triggers AI allocation across all configured accounts
Talent sourcing	Hours: post job, review applicants, verify credentials, negotiate contract	Hours → Minutes: AI searches marketplace, ranks matches, prepares contracts
Financial reporting	Monthly: export data from 4 systems, reconcile, build report	Real-time: always-current dashboard with AI-generated insights
Governance cycle	Days/weeks: email threads, spreadsheet votes, manual result calculation	Hours: proposal → vote → result → treasury action, all on-platform
OKR tracking	Manual: update spreadsheet weekly, calculate variance, share with team	Automatic: AI monitors progress, flags risks, suggests corrective actions

The AI Layer: Your Organization's Chief of Staff

Every morning when the platform opens, Kogi's AI runs a cross-platform review and delivers a briefing that replaces what would otherwise require checking 10 separate systems. For operational leaders, this is the most immediately impactful capability.

- Outstanding invoices flagged with one-click resolution actions
- Projects at risk of missing milestones with specific intervention suggestions
- OKR progress compared to targets with recommended actions if off-track
- Governance votes closing soon with proposal summaries and quick-vote options
- Talent opportunities in the marketplace that match current project needs

SCENARIO: A SMALL AGENCY'S MONDAY MORNING

It's Monday. The agency principal opens Kogi. The AI briefing shows: Client A's invoice (\$8,500) is 9 days overdue — a payment reminder is drafted and ready to send. The development sprint for Client B is blocked on a QA resource — two vetted QA contractors are queued for outreach. Revenue is at 71% of quarterly target with 38 days remaining — the AI suggests accelerating one billable milestone and proposes the specific action. The governance vote on the new profit-sharing proposal closes in 22 hours. All four items are actionable with one click. Total time to resolution: 7 minutes.

Module Map for Business Operations

Business Function	Kogi Module	Replaces
Project Management	Work Management System (WMS)	Notion, Asana, Linear, Jira
Business Banking	kogi-bank	Mercury, Relay, traditional business banking
Invoicing & Billing	Exchange + WMS Integration	FreshBooks, Wave, QuickBooks
Payroll	Cooperative Payroll (kogi-bank)	Gusto, Rippling, ADP (for co-ops)
Talent Sourcing	Marketplace	Upwork, Toptal, LinkedIn Recruiter
Business Intelligence	Analytics (kogi-engine)	Tableau, Looker, spreadsheet dashboards
Contract Management	Tools + Exchange	DocuSign + separate contract database
Team Communication	Community Spaces	Slack (for structured spaces)
Decision-Making	Governance Module	Email threads, Loomio, SurveyMonkey

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The Technical View

Architecture, components, and integration for engineering teams

FOR: DEVELOPERS, ENGINEERS, ARCHITECTS, TECHNICAL LEADS, CTOS

System Architecture Overview

Kogi is a distributed platform built on a polyglot microservices architecture. The system is organized in layers: a kernel/host layer for bare-metal performance, a services layer for domain logic, a platform intelligence layer for analytics and AI, and client layers for web, mobile, and desktop.

Layer	Technology	Responsibility
Kernel & Host	Zig (kernel), Rust (host/server/modules)	OS-level operations, memory management, host node coordination, IPC
Platform Services	Go microservices	Domain logic: auth, portfolio, exchange, bank, office, community, marketplace
Intelligence Engine	Scala 3 (kogi-engine, JVM)	Analytics, recommendations, matching, risk, graph traversal, AI workflows
Build System	Bazel	Hermetic, incremental builds across polyglot monorepo
Web Client	Angular (TypeScript)	Primary browser-based UI; SPA with module-based routing
Mobile Clients	Kotlin (Android), Swift (iOS)	Native mobile apps; real-time sync with platform services
Desktop Client	Java	Cross-platform desktop; full feature parity with web
Data Layer	PostgreSQL + Apache Kafka + Redis	Persistent storage + event streaming + caching

kogi-engine: The Intelligence Substrate

kogi-engine is the central analytics and intelligence platform. Written in Scala 3, it exposes a unified KogiEngine facade that composes 15+ specialized sub-engines. All platform event streams flow through kogi-engine for processing, enrichment, and action generation.

Sub-Engine	Function
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AnalyticsEngine	Event ingestion, module metrics, portfolio signals, system snapshots
TelemetryEngine	Platform data envelope processing, flow ledger, component flow statistics
DataStreamingEngine	In-memory event stream with pub/sub subscriptions and time-window queries
RecommendationEngine	User profiling, collaborative/content-based/hybrid/contextual recommendations, feedback loop
PersonalizationEngine	Content delivery adaptation, A/B experiments, multi-armed bandit, persona lifecycle
MatchEngine	Multi-dimensional matching of users, components, resources, and analytics artifacts
GraphEngine	Dependency graph traversal, cycle detection, CPM critical path, topological sort, diff
RiskEngine	Portfolio health scoring, persona-aware risk adjustment, optimization plans
SearchEngine	Full-text + tag/metadata indexing with personalized re-ranking
AllocationEngine	Bid scoring and allocation selection for marketplace game mechanics
IncentiveEngine	KP (Kogi Points) ledger, streaks, reward application, incentive profiles
GameEngine	Listings, bids, allocation orchestration, incentive application for marketplace

Platform Interfaces

Interface	Protocol	Key Endpoints / Commands
gRPC Server (EngineGrpcServer)	gRPC / protobuf	Control, Status, Ingest, Snapshot — port 9100
HTTP REST (GraphEngineAPIServer)	HTTP/1.1 JSON	GET /health, POST /load, GET /impact, GET /topo, GET /cycles, GET /diff
Engine CLI (KogiEngineCli)	stdin/stdout JSON	control, status, ingest, snapshot, query, search, match, graph-*
Graph CLI (GraphEngineCLI)	stdin/stdout text/JSON/DOT	impact, closure, topo, critical, cycles, diff, export
Programmatic API	Scala in-process	Builder API, typed Either results, mutation methods

Distributed Node Architecture

Kogi is designed for distributed deployment. Each deployment node runs the full platform stack. Nodes coordinate through a consensus mechanism (Raft/Bully leader election) embedded in

ShangoOS. The kogi-engine can be federated across nodes using Kafka event bus for stream sharing and CRDT-based merge strategies for distributed state convergence.

- Leader election: Raft consensus for coordination; Bully algorithm as fallback
- Event streaming: Apache Kafka for inter-node event distribution
- State sync: CRDT-based merge for recommendation profiles and graph state
- Caching: Redis for user profiles, session state, and hot data paths

Portfolio Data Model

The portfolio system is the foundational data model of the platform. All work, resources, and artifacts are organized within a hierarchical container taxonomy:

Component Type	Category	Description
Portfolio	Item	Top-level container for an entire work portfolio
Program	Item	Collection of related projects with shared strategic objective
Project	Item	A bounded work unit with defined scope and deliverables
Resource	Item	A tracked asset, person, or capability within a project
Artifact	Item	A deliverable, document, or output from a project
Binder / Book / Record	Container	Organizational containers for grouping components
Registry / Archive	Container	System-level containers for classification and historical storage

Key Design Principles

- Single data graph: all modules share one underlying data model — no data duplication, no sync lag
- Event-driven: all state changes propagate as events through kogi-engine for consistent materialization
- Approval-first AI: agents suggest and prepare; users confirm before consequential actions execute
- Immutable audit trail: all financial operations and governance actions logged with full provenance
- Modular deployment: each module can be deployed independently; value compounds as more are activated

Closing: One Platform, Many People

Whether you are a freelancer managing five clients, a cooperative running democratic governance, a business owner trying to stop switching between apps, or an engineer evaluating a system to build on — Kogi is built with you in mind.

The platform's ambition is simple to state and hard to execute: give independent workers and worker-owned organizations the same quality of tools, financial infrastructure, and intelligence that large corporations take for granted — but built from the ground up for how those workers actually work.

Every module in Kogi was designed to solve a real problem that real workers face. And every module is more powerful because of every other module. That integration — the ability of your work management to talk to your banking, your AI to understand your governance, your marketplace to respond to your sprint board — is what makes Kogi different from every other tool in this space.

KOGI PLATFORM · UNDERSTANDING KOGI

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